07-29 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle Schools Require Community Service Hours?

① In many countries around the world, a middle-school student is asked to complete a certain number of hours each year helping in the community — sweeping a park, reading to small children, planting trees, or serving meals at a shelter for the homeless. Some schools in our country have started the same tradition: 20 or 30 hours of community service per school year, counted in a small "service record". A question, however, is quietly growing: **is it fair to require service, or does a forced good deed lose its meaning?** In my view, **required community service, when designed well, is one of the best lessons a middle school can offer — and the requirement is worth keeping.**

② The first reason is about **building the habit**. Kindness is not a talent we are born with; it is a skill we learn from regular practice, like playing the piano or writing good sentences. Without a clear, shared standard, many busy students will simply never start. Once a school says, "Everyone needs 20 hours," it removes the awkward question, "Should I go or not?" After a year or two, the habit often becomes a small, warm part of who a student is. A 2026 study in Nanjing found that **68%** of students who had completed two years of required service continued to volunteer in Grade 9, even when it was no longer needed.

③ The second reason is **learning through doing**. Many topics we study in class — poverty, the environment, the elderly, children with special needs — remain distant words on a page. Service hours turn them into real faces. A student who spends a Saturday morning helping a blind neighbour cross a busy road understands "disability" in a way no textbook can teach. A student who plants saplings on a hill feels climate change as a quiet ache in the back and a clear dirt under the fingernails. Grades may fade, but these lessons stay.

④ Still, a common objection says, "If we force a good deed, it is no longer a good deed." This sounds neat, but it confuses two different things. It is true that the best motivation — kindness from the heart — cannot be forced. But required service does not forbid inner kindness; it simply **creates the chance** to meet it. Many students arrive at their first day of service with a little complaint ("It's Saturday, why am I up so early?") and leave with a warm, surprised feeling in the chest. The feeling was always inside; the requirement only opened the door. After that, the student chooses whether to come back — and many do.

⑤ A second worry is about **time**. Middle-school students are already busy, especially in Grade 9. Isn't 20 hours a year one more pressure? This worry is reasonable, and schools

must answer it carefully. Required hours should be **spread across the term** (one hour every two weeks, for example), and schools should give a **menu** of choices: weekday afternoon, weekend morning, holiday projects, small online help. A well-designed programme takes no more from study than a single long film a month — and, like exercise, it actually gives clearer focus in the lessons that follow.

⑥ A third worry is about **fakery**. If hours are required, some students may simply sign a form without doing real work, and some parents may sign it for them. This is a real risk. The answer, however, is not to remove the requirement but to **check it better**. Schools can ask for a short written reflection after each service day, require a signature from the real host (not just a parent), and send a teacher to visit a few sites each term. Service with a light, fair check is far more useful than no service at all.

⑦ Some say that different families have different situations; not every student can travel to a big shelter downtown. That is absolutely true. A strong programme includes service **close to home**: tidying a neighbour's garden, teaching a younger cousin to read, helping a classmate with study, joining a small group clean-up in the school yard. The definition of "community" should start at our own door.

⑧ Beyond the rules, there is one deeper reason to keep the requirement. Middle school is the age when a young person is deciding, quietly, what kind of adult to become. A school that only says "study hard" teaches one lesson. A school that says "study hard, and also give 20 hours to someone outside yourself" teaches two. Both lessons will be needed on every long road ahead.

⑨ So yes, let us keep the hours — and give them good design, honest checks, and rich choices. A required 20 hours is, in the end, a very small price for a very large gift: the young, early discovery that our lives are bigger than ourselves.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main opinion about required community service?

A. It should be stopped because a forced good deed has no meaning.
B. It should be reduced to 2 hours per year.
C. When designed well, required service is one of the best lessons a middle school can offer and should be kept.
D. Only Grade 9 students should do it.

2. What did the 2026 study in Nanjing find?

A. Students who did service became ill more often.
B. 68% of students who had completed two years of required service continued to volunteer in Grade 9, even without the rule.

C. Service had no effect on students' habits.
D. Forced service made most students unhappy forever.

3. How does the writer answer the claim that "if we force a good deed, it is no longer a good deed"?

A. He agrees completely.
B. He says the requirement cannot force inner kindness, but it can create the chance to meet it; many students arrive with complaints and leave with warm feelings.
C. He says schools should force even more hours.
D. He says kindness does not really exist.

4. What is the writer's answer to the worry about students pretending to finish hours?

A. Remove the requirement completely.
B. Keep the requirement but check it better — with short reflections, a real host's signature, and occasional teacher visits.
C. Punish every student with failing marks.
D. Ask parents to do the service instead.

5. Which of the following is NOT an example of "community close to home" in paragraph ⑦?

A. Tidying a neighbour's garden.
B. Teaching a younger cousin to read.
C. Joining a small school yard clean-up.
D. Travelling overseas to build a big hospital.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】首段末句
【解析】设计得当的义工要求应保留。A/B/D 均偏。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "68%... continued to volunteer in Grade 9..."
【解析】68% 自发继续志愿。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题

【定位】第④段 "it simply creates the chance to meet it."
【解析】要求不能强制善意但可打开机会之门。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "check it better... reflection... signature... teacher visits..."
【解析】加强检查但不取消要求。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段 列举的"近社区"例子
【解析】D 非文中例子。A/B/C 均为例子。故选 D。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **shelter** [n.] 收容所
- **poverty** [n.] 贫困
- **sapling** [n.] 小树苗
- **reflection** [n.] 反思
- **motivation** [n.] 动机